

Software & License Management Policy

Policy No: POL-IT-010 | Version: v1.7 | Department: IT Asset Management | Effective: March 17, 2026

1. PURPOSE

This policy establishes standards for the procurement, installation, use, and retirement of software across the organization. It ensures legal compliance with software licensing agreements, protects against security risks, and optimizes software expenditure.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all software installed on company-owned devices, virtual machines, cloud environments, and any personally-owned devices used for company work.

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4. SOFTWARE PROCUREMENT

4.1 Approval Process

All software purchases and subscriptions must go through the following process:

- Step 1: Employee submits software request via IT Helpdesk portal with business justification.
- Step 2: IT team reviews for security, compatibility, and existing alternatives.
- Step 3: Legal reviews licensing terms for compliance and risk.
- Step 4: Finance approves budget for purchases above INR 5,000.
- Step 5: IT procures and deploys the approved software.

4.2 Prohibited Procurement

- Employees must not purchase software on the company's behalf using personal funds for reimbursement without prior written approval.
- Trial versions must not be used for production work without formal approval process.

5. APPROVED SOFTWARE LIST

The IT department maintains an Approved Software List (ASL) — available on the IT portal. The following categories of software are pre-approved for standard use:

5.1 Productivity & Collaboration

- Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, Outlook) — all employees.
- Zoom Enterprise, Google Meet — for external video conferencing.
- Confluence, Jira — project management and documentation.

5.2 Development Tools

- VS Code, IntelliJ IDEA, PyCharm — IDE options for developers.
- Git, GitHub Enterprise, Bitbucket — version control.
- Docker Desktop, Kubernetes tools — container management.

5.3 Security Tools

- CrowdStrike / Defender — endpoint protection (auto-deployed).
- LastPass Enterprise — password management.
- Cisco AnyConnect — VPN client.

6. INSTALLATION & DEPLOYMENT

- Only IT-approved software from the Software Center or IT portal may be self-installed.
- Administrator rights are not granted to standard users. Contact IT for software installation assistance.
- Software must only be downloaded from official vendor websites or the company software repository.
- Portable apps and browser extensions require IT approval before use.
- Unauthorized software discovered during audits will be removed without prior notice.
- Installing software for personal use on company devices is prohibited.

7. LICENSE COMPLIANCE

7.1 License Tracking

IT maintains a Software Asset Management (SAM) database tracking all software licenses, expiry dates, and assigned users. Employees must promptly report changes in software usage to ensure accurate tracking.

7.2 Employee Obligations

- Use software only on the number of devices permitted by the license agreement.
- Do not share licensed software or license keys with unauthorized individuals.

- Do not copy, reproduce, or distribute licensed software.
- Report unused software licenses to IT so they can be reallocated or cancelled.

7.3 Audit Rights

The company conducts quarterly software audits to verify compliance. Employees must cooperate fully with audit activities. Non-compliance with license agreements can expose the company to significant financial and legal penalties.

8. OPEN SOURCE SOFTWARE

Open source software (OSS) can offer significant value but must be managed carefully to avoid license compliance, security, and intellectual property risks.

- All open source components used in company products must be reviewed and approved by the IT Security team.
- Understand the OSS license type before use: permissive (MIT, Apache 2.0) vs. copyleft (GPL).
- GPL-licensed code embedded in proprietary products requires legal review.
- Maintain an inventory of all OSS components used in products (Software Bill of Materials - SBOM).
- Monitor OSS components for known security vulnerabilities (CVEs) using automated scanning tools.

Note: When in doubt about OSS license compatibility, always consult the Legal team before use.

9. SOFTWARE RETIREMENT

9.1 End-of-Life Software

Software that has reached end-of-life (EOL) by the vendor poses significant security risks. EOL software must be replaced or retired within 90 days of vendor announcement.

9.2 Decommissioning Process

- IT publishes a list of software scheduled for retirement on the IT portal.
- Affected employees are notified 60 days before decommissioning.
- Migration paths and approved replacements are communicated by IT.
- On the decommission date, software is remotely uninstalled from all managed devices.

9.3 Data Preservation

Before retiring any software, employees must ensure all data is exported and migrated to approved systems. IT will provide assistance and a transition guide for major software changes.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, the undersigned, confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with this policy. I understand that violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action.

Employee
Name: _____

Date: _____

Employee
ID: _____

Signature: _____

Department
: _____

Manager: _____

For questions regarding this policy, contact the IT Department at it-policy@company.com